

## LEC12 - Sexuality

### Defining Sexuality

- Sexual identity, sexual practices, sexual attractiveness, and sexual desires
- “Ones capacity for sexual feelings”
- Not absolute

### Defining Sexual Orientation

**Heterosexual:** Attraction to someone of a different sex

**Homosexual:** Attraction to the same sex

**Bisexual:** Attraction to either sex

**Pansexual:** Attraction regardless of gender identity of biological sex

**Asexual:** Little or no attraction or interest in sexual activity

### Measuring Sexuality

#### **Identity**

- Orientation

#### **Behaviour**

- Experiences

#### **Desire**

- Can be measured
- Measuring sexuality in a social world requires a degree of precision
- Sociologists are moving away from binaries such as gender and sexuality
- Masculinity is heavily associated with heterosexuality

### Canadian Sexuality Trends

- By age 15-24, 60% of Canadians have had VPI
  - Varies by age, ethnicity, religion, and sexual orientation
  - Mostly in the form of committed, monogamous relationships
    - Also varies by gender and sexual orientation
- Older Canadians are also sexually active
  - Activity drops off with age